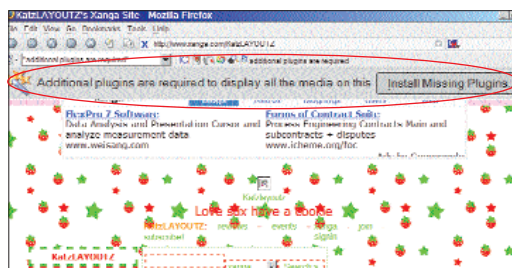


Digital Leisure | Lead Feature

Trojan detector running. If you're using Internet Explorer as your primary Web browser, we recommend installing the Windows Live Toolbar—head to ideas.live.com for this and other Windows Live tools.



Modern browsers can detect missing plugins, prompting you to install them

Finally, make sure you read the sidebar *Playing The E-mail Game* before you proceed with the rest of this article. For the path to nirvana is strewn with danger and peril.

Miniclip.com www.miniclip.com

This is one of the largest online databases of games. The site offers a range of activities, from Flash and Shockwave content, which can be played via a Web browser, to downloadable content that can be installed in the traditional manner. Note that the site mixes its content offering—some of the games available are free, and Miniclip.com claims there are about 150 such games on its site. Other offerings require a small payment in order to enjoy the entire game. Free or otherwise, some of the games available require you to create an account. The signup is used to track your progress, rank you on a worldwide leader board, and even enter you into competitions.

Make sure you know what you are signing on for before divulging personal information.

Interestingly, the Web site

Playing The E-mail Game

Since there is no such thing as a free lunch, doubly so online, expect to divulge personal information on a regular basis. Web sites will cajole or force you to sign in, in order to experience whatever they have on offer. The wisest course to take in such matters is to create a trash e-mail ID. Choose a well-known Web mail provider such as hotmail.com or yahoo.com, and create an ID meant for signing up for anything online. Say you've created spamme-here@<provider>.com—now use this ID to sign up for all and sundry. One spam ID to bring them all; keep your personal and professional e-mail accounts clean

offers a toolbar for IE that lists the latest games available, allows you to preview these games, and also to maintain a cache of your favourite titles.

Monster Truck

www.miniclip.com/monstertruck/monstertruck.htm



Monstertruck

Crush cars, take to the air, and perform incredibly over-the-top stunts in this side-scrolling, action-packed monster truck thriller.

Robot Rage

www.miniclip.com/robotrage.htm



Robot Rage

Build the best robot you can. Win battles to earn points and use points to buy upgrades. Take on the world!

MotherLoad

www.miniclip.com/motherload.htm



Motherload001

Use your digger to excavate as much ore as possible. Use the money you earn to upgrade your digger and move deeper and deeper underground, to unearth the mysteries from below

Heli Attack 3

www.miniclip.com/heliattack3.htm

Destroy all enemy units to progress through snow, jungle,



Heli Attack

canyon lands and lab levels... featuring over 30 weapons.

Red Beard

www.miniclip.com/redbeard.htm



red beard

Activate the LIFTS and PLAT-FORMS by collecting the MATCHING coloured balls. Collect the gold to complete the level. A fiendish and diabolical game! Aaarrrrr!

Also Try

Canyon Glider: www.miniclip.com/canyonglider.htm

Radical Aces: www.miniclip.com/aces/index.htm

Rack Runners: www.miniclip.com/rackrunners.htm

David: www.miniclip.com/david.htm

Snooker Multiplayer: www.miniclip.com/snooker.htm

Li'l Games

www.lilgames.com

This is not the most professional of sites. It opens with a lame April fool's joke proclaiming a "super stupendous, inspiring, emotional roller coaster inducing, crazy wacky ultimate game ever created or even imagined ever in the history of Web entertainment!!" That apart, it is littered with misspellings, dead links, and incorrect explanations for games. But hey, there are some pretty fun titles around!

The site is a good portal for a range of addictive games from word puzzles to basketball. For the lazy among us, the site also offers a few cartoon strips and a bunch of e-cards to while away